> for comestibles and raw materials has passed. We find ourselves facing an economic reality in which industry assumes an ever more decisive role … The result has been a repositioning, a hierarchic arrangement of capitalist countries in the form of a pyramid and, consequently, the rise of intermediate centres of accumulation – that are also middle capitalist powers – which brought us to speak about the emergence of a sub-imperialism (Marini 1977a:25. Author's translation).

Both imperialism and sub-imperialism occur in a capitalist system organised into centres and peripheries, in an historical relationship that is modified over time and based on international divisions of labour that also change over time (with adjustments of the use-values that each produces, with new forms of value extraction and with the integration of production systems). At the root of sub-imperialism as a new link in the imperialist chain:

> One thus observes the rise of a new international division of labour, which relocates stages of industrial production – it is worth remembering, unequally – to dependent countries while advanced countries specialise in higher stages; at the same time, financial control mechanisms and technology over the whole system are perfected. Capital's circulation on the world scale is intensified and deepened at the same time as accumulation is diversified. Meanwhile tendencies of capital accumulation concentrate and centralise progress even though now also in the interests of nations of an intermediate organic composition. *From a strictly economic perspective,* this is consistent with sub-imperialism (Marini 2012:40. Emphasis in the original).

At system level and, in strictly economic terms, the historical foundation of sub-imperialism came about in the 1960s and 1970s when a few social formations arrived at the phase of monopoly and finance capitalism and at an intermediate level of the organic composition of capital: 'Sub-imperialism corresponds with, on the one hand, the rise of intermediate points in global capitalism's organic composition as the integration of production systems intensifies – and, on the other hand, the arrival of a dependent economy at the monopoly and finance capital phase' (Marini 2012:41). This transformation at the same time explains the change in the imperialist dynamic *tout court* and the rise of sub-imperialist formations in the context of the expansion of world capital accumulation. This is a dialectical movement whereby the external (capital export) is internalised